May 23, 2025

Tracianna L. Winston
Designated Agency Ethics Official/
Chief Counsel Ethics Specialty Team
Department of Veterans Affairs
810 Vermont Ave, NW, Suite 1175
Washington, DC 20005

Dear Ms. Winston:

The purpose of this letter is to describe the steps that I will take to avoid any actual or apparent conflict of interest in the event that I am confirmed for the position of Assistant Secretary (Enterprise Integration) for the Department of Veterans Affairs. It is my responsibility to understand and comply with commitments outlined in this agreement.

SECTION 1 – GENERAL COMMITMENTS

As required by the criminal conflicts of interest law at 18 U.S.C. § 208(a), I will not participate personally and substantially in any particular matter in which I know that I have a financial interest directly and predictably affected by the matter, or in which I know that a person whose interests are imputed to me has a financial interest directly and predictably affected by the particular matter, unless I first obtain a written waiver, pursuant to 18 U.S.C. § 208(b)(1), or qualify for a regulatory exemption, pursuant to 18 U.S.C. § 208(b)(2). I understand that the interests of the following persons are imputed to me:

- Any spouse or minor child of mine;
- Any general partner of a partnership in which I am a limited or general partner;
- Any organization in which I serve as an officer, director, trustee, general partner, or employee, even if uncompensated; and
- Any person or organization with which I am negotiating or have an arrangement concerning prospective employment.

In the event that an actual or potential conflict of interest arises during my appointment, I will consult with an agency ethics official and take the measures necessary to resolve the conflict, such as recusal from the particular matter or divestiture of an asset.

If I have a managed account or otherwise use the services of an investment professional during my appointment, I will ensure that the account manager or investment professional obtains my prior approval on a case-by-case basis for the purchase of any assets other than cash, cash equivalents, investment funds that qualify for the regulatory exemption for diversified mutual funds and unit investment trusts at 5 C.F.R. § 2640.201(a), obligations of the United States, or municipal bonds.

I will receive a live ethics briefing from a member of the ethics office after my confirmation but not later than 15 days after my appointment pursuant to the ethics program regulation at 5 C.F.R. § 2638.305. Within 90 days of my confirmation, I will submit my Certification of Ethics Agreement Compliance which documents my compliance with this ethics agreement.

I will not modify this ethics agreement without your approval and the approval of the U.S. Office of Government Ethics (OGE) pursuant to the ethics agreement requirements contained in the financial disclosure regulation at 5 C.F.R. § 2634.803(a)(4).

SECTION 2 – J&G REAL ESTATE INVESTMENTS, INC.

Upon confirmation, I will resign from my position as President of my S Corporation, which does business as J&G Real Estate Investments, Inc. I will continue to have a financial interest in this entity, but I will not provide any services material to the production of income. Instead, I will receive only passive investment income from it. As Assistant Secretary, I will not participate personally and substantially in any particular matter that to my knowledge has a direct and predictable effect on the financial interests of J&G Real Estate Investments, Inc., unless I first obtain a written waiver, pursuant to 18 U.S.C. § 208(b)(1).

SECTION 3 – THE NATIONAL ACADEMY OF PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION

I will retain, in name only, my unpaid position as a Fellow in the National Academy of Public Administration. Pursuant to the impartiality regulation at 5 C.F.R. § 2635.502, for as long as I retain this position, I will not participate personally and substantially in any particular matter involving specific parties in which I know the National Academy of Public Administration is a party or represents a party, unless I am first authorized to participate, pursuant to 5 C.F.R. § 2635.502(d).

SECTION 4 – RESIGNATIONS

I previously resigned from my positions at Brightstar Innovations Group, LLC, and its subsidiary, Operation Nitrile, when Brightstar Innovations Group, LLC was sold in January 2025. Pursuant to the impartiality regulation at 5 C.F.R. § 2635.502, for a period of one year after my resignation from each of these entities, I will not participate personally and substantially in any particular matter involving specific parties in which I know either entity is a party or represents a party, unless I am first authorized to participate, pursuant to 5 C.F.R. § 2635.502(d). In addition, pursuant to the impartiality regulation at 5 C.F.R. § 2635.502, I will not participate personally and substantially in any particular matter involving specific parties in which I know a former client of mine is a party or represents

a party for a period of one year after I last provided service to that client, unless I am first authorized to participate, pursuant to 5 C.F.R. § 2635.502(d).

SECTION 5 – GanD, INC. AND HESSIAN LABS, INC.

I previously resigned from my positions with GanD, Inc. and Hessian Labs, Inc. I hold vested restricted stock in GanD, Inc. and Hessian Labs, Inc. I do not hold any other equity interest in either entity. I will not participate personally and substantially in any particular matter that to my knowledge has a direct and predictable effect on the financial interests of either entity, unless I first obtain a written waiver, pursuant to 18 U.S.C. § 208(b)(1).

SECTION 6 – PUBLIC POSTING

I have been advised that this ethics agreement and the Certification of Ethics Agreement Compliance will be posted publicly, consistent with the public information law at 5 U.S.C. § 552, on the website of the U.S. Office of Government Ethics with ethics agreements of other presidential nominees who file public financial disclosure reports.

Sincerely,

JOHN BARTRUM

Digitally signed by JOHN BARTRUM
Date: 2025.05.23 17:59:06 -04'00'

John Bartrum